

Lucas Furer

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Dear Optiver Recruitment Team,

I am writing to apply for the Graduate Software Engineer position at Optiver in Amsterdam. I recently graduated from TU Delft with an MSc in Computer Science, and I am eager to apply my background in C++, high-performance computing, and algorithmic problem-solving to the technically demanding environment of financial markets.

What attracts me to Optiver is the opportunity to work on mission-critical systems where speed, reliability, and precision have a direct impact. I am interested in the financial industry and excited by the prospect of working closely with traders, researchers, and engineers to solve complex problems in a fast-moving environment. The combination of challenging technical work, continuous improvement, and close collaboration strongly appeals to me.

During my Master's thesis, I implemented a fast multipole N-body solver and integrated it into t-SNE, with the core work developed in C++. This project required me to work with computationally intensive algorithms and consider performance when designing and implementing the solution. My Bachelor's thesis also involved developing a C++ implementation to study the behaviour of ray reflection distributions under microstructure smoothing. Through these projects, I developed a strong interest in tackling technically complex problems and building efficient, well-structured software.

Alongside my academic work, I have gained experience working collaboratively in software development. During my internship at Feedback Analytics, I led a five-person team and worked directly with the client to gather requirements and deliver a visualization tool. This experience strengthened my ability to communicate clearly, take ownership, and collaborate effectively while keeping a project moving forward. I have also worked with Java, Python, SQL, Linux, Git, and CI/CD tooling, giving me experience across different areas of the software development process.

I am an eager learner who enjoys exploring new technologies and challenging assumptions to find better solutions. Optiver's emphasis on continuous learning, engineering excellence, and using cutting-edge technology to solve problems in data-rich financial markets makes this opportunity particularly exciting to me. I would welcome the opportunity to learn from and contribute to Optiver's engineers, traders, and researchers while continuing to develop as a software engineer.

Thank you for considering my application. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my technical background, analytical mindset, and interest in the financial industry could contribute to Optiver.

Sincerely,
Lucas Furer